

Optional query expansion setting

When query expansion is enabled during retrieval, the question first goes through a local short-context model rewrite into a handful of synonymous variants (strictly in the English language). Each variant is retrieved via the pipeline above; the variants' **text-channel** and **captions-channel** hits are then RRF-fused with the original's full multi-channel hits. Image / id channels fire only on the original — they don't benefit from textual rewording, and excluding them prevents repeat-firing amplification.

